

NE.4 Where to File Directory

The one map Nebraska publishes, the list it does not, and the offices that exist whatever your county decided.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. Nebraska adopts one state building code and then makes enforcing it optional: the code is "the legally applicable code regardless of whether the county, city, or village has provided for the administration or enforcement" of it, no county or city has to issue a building permit, and no state agency may inspect a private house. What does not depend on any of that: the **state electrical inspection**, enforced at the power meter; the **energy code**, which you build to yourself; and the **septic and well filings**, which are made by the professional or by you. Confirm every item with the office that will actually handle your parcel before you rely on it. Every web address here was checked in September 2026. The electrical map changes when a city adopts an inspection ordinance; the building-permit answer changes when a county board passes a resolution. Neither is announced anywhere central.

THE MAP EXISTS FOR ELECTRICAL — AND IT IS THE LOOKUP THAT MATTERS

State electrical inspection "shall not apply within the jurisdiction of any county, city, or village which provides by resolution or ordinance" its own wiring standards and its own inspection "by a certified electrical inspector" (§ 81-2125(1)). The State Electrical Division publishes exactly who has done that, as a map. When this kit was assembled the map's data layer held 43 features and broke down as follows — **everyone not on this list is inspected by the state.**

Who runs their own electrical inspection — SED layer, September 2026

Level	Jurisdictions
Counties (5 of 93)	Lancaster, Hall, Dodge, Douglas, Sarpy
Cities (14)	Lincoln, Omaha, Bellevue, Papillion, Gretna, Ralston, Grand Island, Hastings, Kearney, Fremont, Norfolk, York, South Sioux City (which also covers the villages of Jackson and Homer) and Hickman
The traps inside those counties	La Vista (Sarpy County), Waverly (Lancaster County) and Boys Town (Douglas County) are each explicitly State of Nebraska on the layer, despite the county around them. So are the villages of Lancaster, Dodge and Douglas counties. Look the parcel up; do not infer from the county

The one address to write down

electrical.nebraska.gov/nsed-inspection-gis-mapping — the Division's notice page, which links the interactive map. Enter the address; the parcel's inspector jurisdiction and district inspector are shown on the map itself.

A local program must meet the state standard and may exceed it; a subdivision that runs one files its ordinance with the board and may not charge a state licensee a local license fee (§ 81-2130). Where the map says **State of Nebraska**, the request for inspection, the fees and the clocks in NE.2 and NE.3 are yours; where it names a city or county, that program's permit replaces the state's and its fee schedule applies — ask.

NO LIST EXISTS FOR BUILDING PERMITS — HERE IS THE CHECK YOU RUN INSTEAD

No state agency publishes which of Nebraska's 93 counties or its cities and villages issue building permits, and this is not an oversight: § 71-6406(7) makes administration optional, § 23-172 lets a county adopt a code by resolution, and nothing requires anyone to report it.

Any guide that gives you a number is guessing. The honest path is three questions, each to the office that holds the answer.

Three questions, three offices

	Ask	What you are asking, and why
1	The county clerk	Two questions. Has the county board adopted a building code by resolution under § 23-172 — and which editions? And does the county's zoning resolution require a permit "prior to the erection ... of any nonfarm building" under § 23-114.04? A county can have the second without the first. A copy of any adopted code must be on file "in the office of the clerk" (§ 71-6406(8))
2	The city or village clerk , if you are inside one — or near one	County codes reach "all of the county except within the limits of any incorporated city or village and except within an unincorporated area where a city or village has been granted zoning jurisdiction and is exercising such jurisdiction" (§ 23-172(5)). Omaha's reach is three miles (§ 14-419(1)); Lincoln's is set by § 15-905; smaller cities have their own zones. Ask the city whether your parcel is inside its extraterritorial jurisdiction, and if so, whose permit
3	The State Electrical Division's map	For the electrical answer, which does not follow the building answer: the two lists are made under different statutes by different resolutions. A county may run its own electrical inspection whatever it decided about a building code, and a city inside such a county may still be state-inspected (La Vista, Waverly)

Get each answer in writing and date it. Email is fine. Write it on the directory page at the end of this document. In three years, when an appraiser asks why there is no building permit on file, that email is your answer — and it is the only one you will have, because the state keeps no record. If the answer is "no code adopted," the state code applies by default (§ 71-6406(1)(b)) and binds the house whether or not anyone

inspects it (§ 71-6406(7)).

THE STATE OFFICES — FOUR AGENCIES, AND WHICH DOES WHAT

Nebraska splits a house between four state agencies, and published guides routinely swap two of them. **Radon is DHHS. Septic is DWEE.**

Who holds which piece of your house

Agency	What it does for a house	Authority
State Electrical Division (NSED)	The request for inspection, homeowner verification, inspections, the map, the Board rules. Online permitting since April 13, 2026	§ 81-2101 et seq.
Department of Water, Energy, and Environment (DWEE)	Three programs: the Nebraska Energy Code (the fact sheet, REScheck, the two-year order); onsite wastewater (Title 124, the general permits, system registration, installer certification); and water wells (Title 134, well registration, driller licensing). Rule PDFs issued before 2025 still say "NDEE" — same agency, renamed	§ 81-1609(1); § 81-15,248; § 46-1207
Department of Health and Human Services (DHHS)	Radon: the county-average determination that decides the under-2.7 exemption, the RRNC requirements document, mitigation-specialist licensing	§ 76-3503(3); § 76-3507
Department of Labor (DOL)	The contractor registry — every trade you hire, with its workers' compensation flag. You do not register	§ 48-2104(1); § 48-2117
Nebraska 811	The One-Call center. Notice "at least two full business days, but no more than ten business days," before excavation	§ 76-2321(1)
Your Natural Resources District (NRD)	Nebraska's 23 NRDs regulate groundwater locally. Ask yours whether it requires a permit or a spacing rule for a domestic well — this kit could not verify a statewide answer and prints none	Ask

LINCOLN, WORKED — THE CITY THAT PUBLISHES ITS CONDITIONS

Lincoln is the example this kit can verify end to end, because Building & Safety publishes its editions and its homeowner conditions. It is also the proof that the state edition is a floor: Lincoln is ahead of the state on every code but energy, which § 71-6406(2)(b) expressly allows.

Lincoln — from the city's own pages, September 2026

	What the city says
Codes	2021 IBC, IRC, IEBC, IMC, IFGC and Uniform Plumbing Code ; 2023 NEC; 2018 IECC — each "& Local Amendments," in Lincoln Municipal Code Titles 20-25
Who may hold a trade permit	Electrical, mechanical and plumbing permits "may only be issued to a licensed contractor or a homeowner for their primary residence"
The homeowner conditions	"Only the owner of the residence can apply for the permit." "You must presently reside in the single-family dwelling or reside there after the construction is complete." "The house cannot be in the process of being prepared for sale, not a rental property, or for intended use for becoming a rental property"
Permit life and inspections	"Permits are valid for 120 days from issuances." "The permit issued must be inspected before any work is concealed and must also be inspected when the installation of the work is completed"
Fees	Building permits: "The minimum fee starts at \$65 and increases from there"; new homes are "calculated based on the square footage with a \$100 deposit." Homeowner trade permits: "All permits will have a minimum \$35 fee"; "Additional inspection trips are \$35"
Electrical	The City of Lincoln and Lancaster County each run their own program (SED layer) — but Waverly and the county's villages are state-inspected
Plumbing	Lincoln is a city of the primary class, so its plumbing board is optional by statute (§ 18-1901(2)); its homeowner plumbing permit exists on the conditions above

Read at lincoln.ne.gov — Building & Safety "Codes," "Homeowner Building Permits," and the homeowner plumbing, mechanical and electrical project pages. The permit portal is permits.lincoln.ne.gov/CitizenAccess. **Treat the fees as perishable**; they are web-page figures, not ordinance figures.

SARPY COUNTY, WORKED — A COUNTY THAT ADOPTED BY RESOLUTION

Sarpy is the example of a county that used § 23-172: **Resolution 2024-150**, adopted and effective **June 4, 2024**, adopts for "the entire unincorporated area of Sarpy County" the **2018** International Building, Residential, Plumbing, Mechanical, Fuel Gas and Energy Conservation Codes (with ICC/ANSI A117.1-2009), replacing the 2012 editions, "as amended."

- **Note the plumbing code: the 2018 IPC, not the UPC.** A county may adopt a plumbing code of its own under § 23-172 and still conform (§ 71-6406(2)(d)); the UPC is only the default where no resolution exists. Inside unincorporated Sarpy, plumb to the IPC.
- **Electrical is a patchwork.** Sarpy County, Bellevue, Papillion and Gretna each run their own inspection program. **La Vista is state-inspected.** The county's portal is co-sarpy-ne.smartgovcommunity.com; Planning & Building is at sarpy.gov/215/Planning-Building.

- The resolution's own narrative says the county adopts on alternate code cycles — expect a 2024-code resolution around 2028. Ask which edition is current the week you file.

OMAHA AND DOUGLAS COUNTY — CONFIRM AT THE COUNTER

Why this kit prints nothing Omaha-specific as fact

Omaha's Planning Department pages (planning.omaha.gov) and Douglas County Environmental Services (dceservices.org) refused every automated request made for this kit — a geographic block that returns "This service is not available in your region." Nothing on those sites could be read. **So the Omaha code edition, its local amendments, its plan-review fee, its frost depth and its homeowner-permit procedure are not printed here**, and any guide that prints them without a date should be checked against the city's own page in a normal browser.

What the statute does say: a city of the metropolitan class **shall** have a plumbing board (§ 18-1901(1)) whose plumbers are "licensed within such cities" (§ 18-1901(6)) and which may "compel the owner or contractor to first submit the plans and specifications for plumbing" (§ 18-1906); the city may regulate construction, "electric wiring, heating, plumbing, pipefitting" within the city and its three-mile zone, "except as to construction on farms for farm purposes" (§ 14-419(1)-(2)); and any code it adopts must conform under § 71-6406 (§ 14-419(4)). On the SED layer, the **City of Omaha, Douglas County** and **Ralston** each inspect their own electrical; **Boys Town** is state-inspected.

What to confirm at the counter, and write on the directory page: the residential and plumbing code editions and where the amendments are published; whether a homeowner may hold the building, plumbing and electrical permits on a primary residence and on what conditions; the fee basis; whether plan review is required and its turnaround; whether the city or the county has jurisdiction over your parcel if it is outside the city limits.

THE SEQUENCE, WHATEVER YOUR COUNTY DECIDED

"No building permit" is not the same as "no paperwork." The real risk is not missing an office — it is doing them in the wrong order, because two of them constrain where the house can physically sit.

The order that avoids re-doing anything

	Step	Which office, and why the order
1	Run the three-question check	County clerk, city clerk, SED map. Before relying on any of the rest
2	Septic professional and site evaluation	The perc test and the Table 2.1 setbacks fix where the drainfield, its reserve area and therefore the house can go. Before you fix the footprint

The order that avoids re-doing anything

	Step	Which office, and why the order
3	Well siting	100 feet from the drainfield, 50 from the tank, both ways round. A variance request needs 10 days and a scaled map
4	County zoning permit, where zoned	It needs the plans "including sanitation, plumbing and sewage disposal" — which is why steps 2 and 3 come first
5	911 address	Administered locally — county or city. The electrical request and the utility need it
6	Local building permit, if one exists	On the local program's form, to its editions, on its schedule
7	Electrical request for inspection	State or local, before any wiring , with the homeowner verification and the power supplier's details. Temporary service five working days ahead
8	Power supplier	Ask the utility what it needs before it sets a meter — the statute says your certificate that inspection was requested; the Division forwards the new-service permit
9	Nebraska 811	At least two full business days before any excavation
10	Floodplain and driveway	The FEMA map and the county or city floodplain administrator; the road authority you touch for a driveway or culvert

STATE-LEVEL ADDRESSES

All confirmed to resolve in September 2026. **We print no phone numbers anywhere in this kit** — they go stale faster than anything else on a printed page, and every office below can be reached from its own site.

Verified September 2026

What you need	Where
Who inspects electrical at my address	electrical.nebraska.gov/nsed-inspection-gis-mapping
The homeowner handout and permit	electrical.nebraska.gov/homeowner-handout
The Act and the Board rules	electrical.nebraska.gov/statutes-rules
Check a contractor's registration	dol.nebraska.gov/conreg/Search
Energy code, fact sheet, REScheck	dwee.nebraska.gov/state-energy-information/energy-codes

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What you need	Where
Septic — Title 124 and the general permits	dwee.nebraska.gov — search "Title 124 Onsite Wastewater Treatment Systems Booklet" (form 23-017)
Wells — Title 134	dwee.nebraska.gov — Water Quality > Groundwater > Water Well Standards
Radon — county data and RRNC requirements	dhhs.ne.gov/Pages/Radon-Data.aspx
Any statute	nebraskalegislature.gov/laws/statutes.php?statute=71-6403
Lincoln codes and permits	lincoln.ne.gov/City/Departments/Building-Safety/Codes;permits.lincoln.ne.gov/CitizenAccess
Sarpy County	sarpy.gov/215/Planning-Building ; co-sarpy-ne.smartgovcommunity.com
Omaha / Douglas County (geo-restricted)	planning.omaha.gov/building-and-development-division ; dceservices.org/permits-and-inspections
Flood map	msc.fema.gov/portal/home

Two addresses people mix up. The Division's map tells you who inspects; the Division's online system (linked from its home page since April 13, 2026) is where the request is filed and paid. And the Legislature's statute pages — not any agency's summary — are where the current text and its effective date live.

YOUR DIRECTORY — FILL THIS IN BEFORE YOU NEED IT**Every office that touches this build, confirmed and dated**

	Item	Date	Notes
☐	County clerk: building code adopted by resolution? Editions? Zoning permit required for a nonfarm dwelling? Answer _____ Date _____		
☐	City or village clerk: am I inside the city or its extraterritorial zone, and whose permit applies? Answer _____ Date _____		
☐	SED map: electrical inspection at my address is STATE or (name the program): Answer _____ Date read _____		

Every office that touches this build, confirmed and dated

	Item	Date	Notes
☐	Building permit office, if one exists, and the editions it reviews to: Office _____ Editions _____		
☐	Septic professional (Master Installer / engineer / REHS) and certificate number: Name _____ Certificate _____		
☐	Well driller and license number — or "self" if I am drilling on my own abode land: Driller _____ License _____		
☐	Natural Resources District, and whether it requires a domestic-well permit: NRD _____ Permit? _____		
☐	Electric utility or public power district, and what it needs before setting a meter: Utility _____ Requires _____		
☐	911 addressing office: Office _____ Address issued _____		
☐	Floodplain administrator, and whether my parcel is in a mapped hazard area: Office _____ In or out _____		
☐	Road authority for the driveway or culvert: Authority _____		
☐	I called Nebraska 811 at least two full business days before any excavation.		

Every statute cited here is free to read at one address you can type:

nebraskalegislature.gov/laws/statutes.php?statute=81-2121 — swap in any section number, comma included (81-15,248). Each page ends with a **Source** line naming every session law that touched it and, after a recent change, an **Effective Date** line. Read that line before you rely on the section. The rules are PDFs: Title 124 (septic) and Title 134 (wells) at **dwee.nebraska.gov**, the electrical Board rules at **electrical.nebraska.gov/statutes-rules**. **One warning:** the Board's rules PDF (April 2024) still calls an unfiled request for inspection a misdemeanor. Since July 18, 2026 the statute says felony. The statute wins. Read September 2026.